

INDIAN STUDENT ROCKETRY TEAM thrustMIT SECURES 3RD IN ASIA, 2ND IN INDIA AT THE INTERNATIONAL ROCKET ENGINEERING COMPETITION

Midland, Texas: June 15-20, 2026—thrustMIT, India's leading student-led rocketry team from the Manipal Institute of Technology, has successfully secured **3rd place in Asia, 2nd place in India, and an Honourable Mention in the Space Dynamics Laboratory (SDL) Payload Challenge** at the 2026 International Rocket Engineering Competition (IREC), competing against some of the world's elite university rocketry teams.

The team placed **3rd among all Asian teams** competing at IREC 2026 and **2nd among all Indian teams** in the field, cementing thrustMIT's position among the region's top student rocketry programs. thrustMIT also earned an **Honourable Mention** in the highly competitive **Space Dynamics Laboratory (SDL) Payload Challenge**, recognising the ingenuity of the team's payload design and execution. These results mark another strong showing for the team on the global stage, building on its record of consistent podium finishes at IREC.

As one of the leading organisations from India, thrustMIT unveiled its recent rocket, **Varuna**, which featured a **Student Researched and Developed (SRAD)** airframe built for the **10K** category and the team's proprietary S.A.M.Y.A. payload, an active magnetic levitation and actuation system that uses precisely tuned electromagnetic fields to achieve stable, contactless control in high-speed flight.



This latest achievement builds upon a legacy of aerospace excellence. The team engineers robust launch vehicles by mastering complex subsystems from advanced composite structures to custom avionics and excels in building complex electrical systems, applying advanced circuit analysis and electromagnetics to engineer highly reliable avionics, telemetry, and payload deployments that can withstand extreme launch forces. thrustMIT's success at IREC 2026 adds to a growing list of milestones, including:

- Engineered and launched **India's first supersonic student rocket**, AgniAstra—the country's first student-built 30,000 ft sounding rocket, breaking the sound barrier at Mach 1.8.
- Crowned **Asia's Top Team** (1st in Asia,

7th Globally) in the 30K COTS category at the Spaceport America Cup / IREC, 2024.

- Secured **2nd place worldwide** in the Space Dynamics Laboratory (SDL) Payload Challenge, IREC 2025.

- Achieved an overall rank of **4th place worldwide** in the 30,000 ft category.

- **4th Place in the James Barrowman Award** (2022), earning global distinction for exceptional precision in aerodynamic modelling and flight physics simulation.

- Received the National **"Young Innovators" Recognition** (2024).

About thrustMIT

Founded in 2016 by a group of dedicated rocket enthusiasts at the Manipal Institute of Technology, thrustMIT is India's premier student-led rocketry team, committed to advancing high-powered rocketry and fostering technological innovation in India. The team designs and manufactures supersonic launch vehicles from the ground up, integrating advanced composite structures, custom avionics, and complex scientific payloads. thrustMIT competes annually at the International Rocket Engineering Competition (IREC) held in Midland, USA the world's largest intercollegiate rocketry competition, sponsored by prominent aerospace organizations including Blue Origin, SpaceX, and the American Institute of Aeronautics and Astronautics (AIAA). For more information, visit thrustmit.in.

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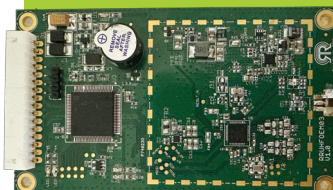
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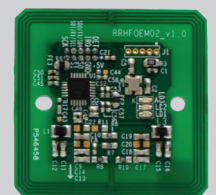
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reader/writer OEM module
with internal antenna



Dimensions: 35 x 35 mm

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